

Outlook

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Test the mule hypothesis without labelling the customer - 2024 control review

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Financial Crime wants to test whether rapid receipt and onward movement forms a network pattern or reflects ordinary customer behaviour. The discussion is currently being driven by anecdotes, and the teams involved are describing the same customers differently.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if shared beneficiaries connect otherwise separate customers?
2. What evidence would instead support that new accounts act as pass-through accounts?
3. How do we rule out that salary, family support or business cash flow explains the pattern?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use June 2024 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards which cases deserve investigation and which monitoring rule needs a better peer group. A useful output would be a short decision pack with no more than five slides and an attached evidence table.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; monthly customer and KYC snapshots; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations. One caution: The output is a triage hypothesis. Do not label a customer a mule without investigation and external evidence.

Regards